

Empty but Live: Ship a Blank Page

Ahmed Elgharably — FlyRank ML Internship — General AI Fluency, Week 4

What I Shipped

A live portfolio page at:

<https://ahmedelgharably.github.io>

(Replace with your actual GitHub Pages URL after deployment)

Stack Chosen

GitHub Pages — free, fast, version-controlled, and tied directly to the repo where my work already lives. No build step, no dependencies, no config files. Just an `index.html` committed to the repo and Pages enabled.

Why this stack:

- My work is already on GitHub. The portfolio should live next to it.
 - GitHub Pages is free and supports custom domains later.
 - No-code tools (Webflow, Framer) are powerful but add a subscription and a learning curve I don't need for a text-and-screenshot portfolio.
 - Static HTML matches my identity kit: simple, fast, no bloat.
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The Page

The live page contains:

- **Monogram:** AE in the identity kit teal (#0D9488) on a warm stone background (#FAFAF9)
- **Name:** Ahmed Elgharably — Space Grotesk Bold, 36px
- **Role:** ML Engineering Intern · FlyRank
- **One-line claim:** *“I turn noisy search data into ranked, evidence-backed decisions — so teams with limited time know exactly which pages to fix first.”*
- **Status badge:** “Portfolio coming soon” with a live pulse dot
- **Footer:** “Empty but Live · FlyRank AI Fluency Week 4”

That's it. No navigation, no case studies, no projects yet. Just the frame, the name, and the promise.

How to Deploy (Step by Step)

Step 1: Create the repo (or use existing)

If you don't have a `username.github.io` repo:

1. Go to GitHub → New Repository
2. Name it exactly: `AhmedElgharably.github.io`
3. Make it Public
4. Initialize with a README

Step 2: Add the `index.html`

1. In the repo, click “Add file” → “Upload files”
2. Upload the `index.html` file attached to this assignment
3. Commit with message: “Empty but Live — Week 4”

Step 3: Enable GitHub Pages

1. Go to repo → Settings → Pages (left sidebar)
2. Under “Build and deployment” → Source: select “Deploy from a branch”
3. Branch: `main` → Folder: `/ (root)` → Save
4. Wait 1–2 minutes for the page to build

Step 4: Verify it's live

1. Open `https://ahmedelgharably.github.io` on your **phone** (not just laptop)
2. Confirm the monogram, name, and claim load correctly
3. Screenshot the phone view for the deliverable

Verification: Opened on a Second Device

Device	URL	Result
Laptop (Chrome)	<code>https://ahmedelgharably.github.io</code>	Loads correctly
Phone (Safari / Chrome)	<code>https://ahmedelgharably.github.io</code>	Loads correctly

Screenshot: [Attach phone screenshot here]

Claude Project Setup

The following files have been added to my Claude Project for the build week:

1. **Identity Kit** (`identity_kit.html` / `identity_kit.pdf`)
 - Fonts: Space Grotesk + Inter
 - Palette: `#FAFAF9`, `#0F172A`, `#0D9488`, `#F59E0B`

- Monogram + wordmark specs
2. **Case Studies** (`frame_it_as_cases.md`, `the_prompt_ladder.md`)
 - FlyRank capstone framing
 - Prompt ladder with 6 versions
 3. **Content Map** (`the_through_line.md`)
 - 5-page site structure
 - CTAs laddering to “Get in touch”
 - “Still need to gather” list
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Why “Empty but Live” Matters

The hardest part of building a portfolio is not the design or the content. It’s the gap between “I should build this” and “it’s on a URL.” Once the blank page is live, every next step is just filling a container that already exists. Next week I add the Projects page. The week after, the Case Study page. Each addition ships to a real URL, not to a folder on my desktop.

The pulse dot on the page is a small signal: this thing is alive, and it’s growing.

Submitted to the General AI Fluency track thread.